

Mark schemes

1.

In this part of the question, candidates will need to demonstrate that they are able to evaluate issues and arguments to support a conclusion if they are to be awarded **more than 15 marks**.

Where there is no **explicit** reference to the data, award a maximum of **21 marks**.

Level 5	Good analysis <u>and</u> good evaluation	22 to 25 marks <i>Mid-Point 24 marks</i>
Level 4	Good analysis <u>but</u> limited evaluation OR Reasonable analysis <u>and</u> reasonable evaluation	17 to 21 <i>Mid-Point 19 marks</i>
Level 3	Reasonable including some correct analysis <u>but</u> very limited evaluation	10 to 16 <i>Mid-Point 13 marks</i>
Level 2	Weak with some understanding	4 to 9 <i>Mid-Point 7 marks</i>
Level 1	Very weak	0 to 3 <i>Mid-Point 2 marks</i>

Introduction	• Unemployment • Demand-side / Supply-side • Types of unemployment
Developing the response to the question: (Application)	Drawing on the information in the extracts: • Labour market reforms (Extract E and Extract F) • EU possibly recovering (Extract E and Extract F) • Supply-side reforms (Extract E) • Effects on firms / workers (Extract E) • Comparisons with other EU countries (Extract E) • The current state of the UK labour market and wage growth (Extract F) • Subsidies / training / introduction of living wage (Extract F) • Benefits cap and limiting JSA (Extract F)
(Analysis)	Arguments as to why demand-side factors may cause further falls: • Rising real incomes in the UK • Increased confidence • Possible increases in domestic investment • Possible increases in FDI • Multiplier effects • Improved export opportunities (if the EU grows) Arguments as to why supply-side factors may cause further falls: • Consideration of the “voluntary” nature of some types of unemployment • Changes to incentives • Changes to benefits forcing people into low paid jobs • Consideration that living wage may actually entice more people into jobs market • So called “carrot and stick” approaches • Changes to structural unemployment • Improvements to mobility (occupational and geographical) • The UK’s experiences under the “Work Programme” and government policy • Focus on particular groups, such as the 16-24 age group or the long term unemployed.
Evaluation	• The UK could be approaching NRU / NAIRU / full capacity, the supply-side may be vital in order to gain further improvements • Both approaches are not mutually exclusive, improvements could be made on both at the same time • Some factors may be beyond the control of the UK, e.g. external demand in the EU, is trade a significant issue? • Consideration of regional aspects – unemployment rates mask a regional issue which is very difficult to solve with policies which aren’t targeted • Consideration that more jobs may be created but the incomes or conditions provided by those jobs maybe are not as good as others <i>Examiners should note that, for some of the weaker or average candidates, parts of the above represent quite sophisticated evaluation and so it is important to ensure that more basic evaluation is adequately rewarded where a genuine effort has been made to display that skill.</i>

Also give credit for

- Reference to the UK / other economies
- Diagrams
- An overall judgement on the issues raised.

It will only be possible for candidates to consider a few of the above. They may also discuss issues not mentioned above.

[25]

2.

A

[1]

3.

Explanation:

For a relevant explanation of circular flow: eg A model which demonstrates the flow of money between households and firms and going on to explain the role of injections/leakages or linking the circular flow to measures of national income/output /expenditure.

For a diagram of the circular flow

Analysis:

For Example: Increased growth in the US could lead to rising disposable income of US citizens who may increase their spending this may be on UK's goods or services which would lead to increased export earnings for the UK which would increase the output of UK firms and therefore AD of which exports are a component which therefore increases the national income of the UK.

Use of appropriate diagrams, eg a diagram showing increased AD on an AD/AS diagram or increased FDI from overseas increasing both AD and AS

Reference to the UK or other economies.

[9]

Level of response	Response	Max 15 marks
3	A good response provides an answer that: - is well organised and develops a selection of the key issues that are relevant to the question - shows sound knowledge and understanding of economic terminology, concepts and principles with few, if any, errors - includes good application of relevant economic principles and, where appropriate, good use of data to support the response - includes well-focused analysis with clear, logical chains of reasoning.	11-15 marks
2	A reasonable response provides an answer that: - focuses on issues that are relevant to the question - shows satisfactory knowledge and understanding of economic terminology, concepts and principles but some weaknesses may be present - includes reasonable application of relevant economic principles and, where appropriate, some use of data to support the response - includes some reasonable analysis but which might not be adequately developed or becomes confused in places.	6-10 marks
1	A weak response provides an answer that: - has one or more relevant issues identified - has some limited knowledge and understanding of economic terminology, concepts and principles but some errors are likely - has very limited application of relevant economic principles and/or data to the question - might have some limited analysis but it may lack focus and/or become confused.	1-5 marks



Relevant issues include:

- likely to increase the pay of the lowest paid employees
- the effect on the distribution of income
- the effect on employment and unemployment
- the effects on different types of workers
- the effects in a competitive labour market
- the effects in a non-competitive labour market
- the effect on firms' costs, profits and competitiveness
- the effect on productivity
- the effect on growth
- the effect on motivation, absenteeism and labour turnover
- the effect on inflation
- the effect on competitiveness and the balance of payments
- diagrammatic representation of the likely effects

[15]



Introduction	- The meaning of inequality - Differences between income and wealth - UK economic performance measures.
Developing the response to the question: Application	Drawing on the information in the extracts: - the rich having a lower MPC and a higher MPS and if incomes of the poor increased consumption would increase (Extract B) - US economic growth and US being the UK's main export partner (Extract B) - Increased income inequality due to reduced union power (Extract C) - trickle-down effects improving living standards (Extract C) - promoting incentives and wealth generation and focusing on financial services (Extract C) - economic progress often depends on saving and innovation (Extract C) - UK financial services making short term with profits and lacking long term investment (Extract C)
Developing the response to the question: Analysis	Arguments how inequality impacts on UK performance: - impacts on consumption and AD - US as the UK's main export market + other export markets - how supply side reforms have affected UK macro-performance - UK's comparative advantage in financial services - increased savings linking to investment - policies impacting on consumption and investment and different income groups - entrepreneurship, "wealth generation" and the free market. - equity vs efficiency arguments - impact on FDI - asset bubbles - UK banking system and the pursuit of long term investment Analysis of each of the UK's four main macro-economic goals or other social goals or current government targets could be included.
Evaluation	- Does inequality in other countries really impact on the UK economy? - The relative amount of inequality - Does the marginal propensity to consume have such a big impact or are there more important considerations (does increased saving by the "top 1%" have such an impact?)

	• The importance of exports and FDI in the economy. • Other considerations such as domestic policy or financial crisis creating bigger impacts. • The relative importance of each macroeconomic performance indicator • Whether Government intervention is necessary for the improvement of the economy and if so in what way?
Also give credit for	• Reference to the UK/other economies • Diagrams • An overall judgement on the issues raised.

It will only be possible for candidates to consider a few of the above. They may also discuss other issues not mentioned above.

[25]

Level of response	Response	Max 10 marks
3	A good response - is well organised and includes at least three relevant, well-developed issues - makes effective use of the numerical/statistical data in Extract C - shows some appreciation of the limitations of the data - includes a supported final judgement concerning the extent to which the NMW affects the international competitiveness of the UK economy	8-10 marks
2	A reasonable response - is fairly well organised and includes at least two relevant and fairly well-developed issues - includes some satisfactory use of the numerical/statistical data in Extract C - may show some limited appreciation of the limitations of the data - at the top of the level, is likely to include a final judgement concerning the extent to which the NMW affects the international competitiveness of the UK economy but the judgement is not very well supported.	4-7 marks
1	A weak response - is very brief and/or lacks coherence - contains very limited or poor use of the data in Extract C - doesn't show any appreciation of the limitations of the data - may include an unsupported judgement concerning the level of the NMW and international competitiveness	1-3 marks



Relevant issues include:

- what is meant by 'competitiveness'
- the relationship between wages, productivity and costs
- the relationship between costs and prices
- the minimum wage in the UK compared to other countries; using the data in the table showing minimum wages at PPP exchange rates and perhaps the data for China
- the extent to which the minimum wage reflects the overall level of wages and hence competitiveness; using the data showing minimum wages relative to full-time median earnings in different countries
- differences in productivity and the relevance of unit labour costs and competitiveness; using the data showing 'GDP per hour worked in a selection of countries'
- the limitations of the data, e.g. only covers a limited range of countries, the productivity data only covers the G7 countries, there isn't any data for a variety of factors that affect competitiveness
- the relevance of other factors that affect competitiveness such as the exchange rate and nonprice factors

[10]



Level of response	Response	Max 25 marks
5	Sound, focused analysis and well-supported evaluation that: - is well organised, showing sound knowledge and understanding of economic terminology, concepts and principles with few, if any, errors - includes good application of relevant economic principles and, where appropriate, good use of data to support the response - includes well-focused analysis with clear, logical chains of reasoning - includes supported evaluation throughout the response and in a final conclusion.	21-25 marks
4	Sound, focused analysis and some supported evaluation that: - is well organised, showing sound knowledge and understanding of economic terminology, concepts and principles with few, if any, errors - includes good application of relevant economic principles and, where appropriate, some good use of data to support the response - includes some well-focused analysis with clear, logical chains of reasoning - includes some reasonable, supported evaluation.	16-20 marks
3	Some reasonable analysis but generally unsupported evaluation that: - focuses on issues that are relevant to the question, showing satisfactory knowledge and understanding of economic terminology, concepts and principles but some weaknesses may be present - includes reasonable application of relevant economic principles and, where appropriate, some use of data to support the response - includes some reasonable analysis but which might not be adequately developed or becomes confused in places - includes fairly superficial evaluation; there is likely to be some attempt to make relevant judgements but these aren't well-supported by arguments and/or data.	11-15 marks

2	A fairly weak response with some understanding that: • includes some limited knowledge and understanding of economic terminology, concepts and principles but some errors are likely • includes some limited application of relevant economic principles and/or data to the question • includes some limited analysis but it may lack focus and/or become confused • includes some evaluation which is weak and unsupported.	6-10 marks
1	A very weak response that: • includes little relevant knowledge and understanding of economic terminology, concepts and principles • includes analysis which is, at best, very weak • includes attempted evaluation which is weak and unsupported.	1-5 marks

Relevant issues and areas for discussion include:

- the stability of the Brazilian economy
- political and social stability
- the rule of law and corruption
- whether the investment is likely to be profitable and whether it is secure
- the nature of any capital controls
- the infrastructure in Brazil
- the skills and abilities of the workforce
- financial and other support from the government
- regulations on business
- the tax regime; both corporate and individual taxes
- availability of finance
- the prospects for future growth of the Brazilian economy
- the size of the Brazilian car market and the potential for future growth
- access and proximity to businesses that can support the car industry, eg component suppliers
- potential for exporting cars from Brazil, eg access to other markets in the Americas
- the prospects for the value of the Brazilian currency, the real, and its stability

[25]

15.

Areas for discussion include:

- definitions of unemployment and deficit reduction
- different types of unemployment
- policies that can be used to reduce unemployment
- methods by which deficit can be reduced, eg tax increases and/or spending cuts by the government
- reasons for current deficit-reduction policy
- effects of deficit reduction on aggregate demand, output and employment
- multiplier effects
- how different methods of reducing the deficit will affect unemployment, e.g. tax increases, cuts in welfare, cuts in direct government spending on goods and services
- recent changes in unemployment in the UK
- supply-side policies can help to reduce unemployment
- how a reduction in the deficit can affect different types of unemployment
- how other components of AD may rise as the government's contribution to AD falls
- factors that may boost AD to replace the effect of lost government expenditure, eg crowding-in effects
- size and pace of any planned deficit reduction
- cuts in government expenditure may or may not fall on areas that affect employment significantly
- time lag between the deficit-reduction policy and the effect on employment
- the impact of events in the rest of the world
- the impact of changes in the sterling exchange rate
- monetary policy may help to offset policy of deficit reduction, eg low UK interest rates and unconventional monetary policy measures have supported the expansion of AD since 2008/9

The use of relevant diagrams to support the analysis should be taken into account when assessing the quality of the student's response to the question.

[25]

16.

Relevant issues include:

- definition of unemployment
- voluntary and involuntary unemployment
- why some unemployment is inevitable
- UK unemployment levels in recent years
- unemployment leads to a loss of output and is a waste of scarce resources
- unemployment and living standards
- benefits of reduced unemployment on the tax and welfare expenditure of government
- unemployment and inequality
- benefits of reduced unemployment on social cohesion
- personal costs of a period of prolonged unemployment
- problem of long-term unemployment, eg hysteresis
- conflict of reducing unemployment with other macroeconomic objectives, eg growth and inflation

The use of relevant diagrams to support the analysis should be taken into account when assessing the quality of the student's response to the question.

[15]

17.

Areas for discussion include:

- UK experience of recent years
- definitions of inflation and deflation
- why price stability is a key objective
- impact of inflation on UK competitiveness
- impact on growth/employment/trade
- the distributional impact of inflation and deflation
- mild v high inflation
- impact of anti-inflationary policies on the economy
- why deflation may lead to even lower spending by consumers/firms
- impact of deflation on the real value of both public and private sector debt
- impact on confidence of households and firms
- effect on business profits
- benefits of deflation
- impact on other macroeconomic objectives
- malign v benign deflation
- policy options to deal with deflation
- extent and magnitude of each problem
- reference to other economies, e.g. Japan, EU , including differences between the situation in the UK and other economies

The use of relevant diagrams to support the analysis should be taken into account when assessing the quality of the student's response to the question.

[25]

18.

B

[1]

19.

Areas for discussion include:

- nature and size of the UK current account deficit in recent years
- why large current account deficits are seen as undesirable, e.g. indicate a lack of competitiveness
- potential benefits of running a current account deficit, e.g. improves living standards in the short run, inflows of FDI to finance the deficit may stimulate growth
- current account deficit has to be financed in some way – either by attracting foreign direct or portfolio investment, by borrowing or by running down reserves.
- policies to correct the deficit are not necessarily desirable, either depreciation of the currency or deflationary policies
- large current account deficit may be seen as unsustainable and foreign lenders may eventually withdraw their investment, leading to a sterling crisis
- if deflationary measures are needed to reduce deficit and this would usually be undesirable due to the effects on output and employment
- so far, long periods of current account deficit do not seem to have been a barrier to achieving other policy objectives
- the changing size of the deficit could be compared to growth, e.g. if the growth of nominal GDP is higher than growth in the deficit then it is less likely to be a serious problem
- UK is relatively successful in attracting overseas investment due to other factors (e.g. low tax rates, viewed as a stable economy) which means that the deficit can be financed.
- a floating exchange rate mean that the government can allow exchange rate to depreciate allowing partial correction of current account deficit – this option is not available to those with a fixed or pegged currency

The use of relevant diagrams to support the analysis should be taken into account when assessing the quality of the student's response to the question.

[25]

21.

D

[1]

22.

Areas for discussion include:

- UK unemployment and how it is measured
- different causes of UK unemployment
- nature of supply-side policies, interventionist v free-market policies
- supply-side policies and the natural rate of unemployment
- the impact of different supply-side policies on unemployment, eg reducing the replacement ratio, measures to improve labour mobility, reductions in corporation tax
- supply-side policies and real wage unemployment
- supply-side policies and long-term unemployment, eg when there is significant structural change, the problem of hysteresis
- relating supply-side policies to unemployment in the UK
- problems and limitations of supply-side policies as a means of reducing unemployment, eg impact on the budget deficit, time lags, effectiveness, government failure
- the benefits of using supply-side policies to reduce unemployment
- demand-side policies as a way of reducing unemployment, ie expansionary monetary and fiscal policy
- exchange-rate policy as a means of reducing unemployment
- benefits and limitations of demand-side policies
- potential conflicts with other policy objectives and ways of reconciling these conflicts
- circumstances when demand-side and/or supply-side policies are most appropriate
- issues relating to equity, inequality and poverty.

The use of relevant diagrams to support the analysis should be taken into account when assessing the quality of the candidate's response to the question.

[25]

23.

Areas for discussion include:

- nature and causes of the budget deficit in the UK
- recent changes in the UK budget deficit
- cyclical and structural deficits
- the budget deficit and the national debt
- possible approaches to reducing the budget deficit, such as: cutting government spending, raising taxes and generating economic growth
- problems associated with large deficits, eg crowding-out effects, impact on interest rates and the UK's credit rating, 'inability' to borrow if no action is taken, the burden on future generations
- impact on aggregate demand and associated multiplier effects
- impact on the various macroeconomic policy objectives in both the short run and the long run
- the impact of cutting different types of government spending, eg spending on welfare benefits, education and health, capital spending
- Keynesian v neo-classical perspectives
- government spending and long-run growth
- whether growth and/or inflation will eliminate the deficit in the long run without significant cuts in government spending
- if cutting the deficit is deemed necessary, whether it should be achieved through cuts in spending or increases in taxation
- the distributional impact of cutting government spending, eg rich versus poor, regional effects
- equity considerations, including inter-generational equity
- reference to other economies, eg Greece, Japan, USA, including differences between the situation in the UK and other economies.

The use of relevant diagrams to support the analysis should be taken into account when assessing the quality of the candidate's response to the question.

[25]

24.

Relevant issues include:

- different types of taxes, eg direct v indirect, progressive, proportional and regressive
- taxation as a withdrawal from the circular flow of income
- how an increase in taxation affects aggregate demand
- the relationship between aggregate demand and each of the main objectives of UK macroeconomic policy, ie unemployment, growth, inflation and the balance of payments
- the different demand-side impacts of different tax changes, eg an increase in the rate of VAT versus a rise in the top rate of income tax
- multiplier effects
- the impact of tax changes on the pattern of demand and hence resource allocation, eg raising taxes on demerit goods
- the significance of elasticities of demand.

The use of relevant diagrams to support the analysis should be taken into account when assessing the quality of the candidate's response to the question.

[15]

25.

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Level 3	Reasonable including some correct analysis <u>but</u> very limited evaluation	10 to 16 <i>Mid-Point 13 marks</i>
Level 2	Weak with some understanding	4 to 9 <i>Mid-Point 7 marks</i>
Level 1	Very weak	0 to 3 <i>Mid-Point 2 marks</i>

Introduction	• Inflation / deflation • MPC / target rate • Monetary Policy • Macroeconomic performance
Developing the response to the question: (application and analysis)	Arguments why a low inflation rate may be damaging: • Indication that an economy may be stagnating and subsequent lack of confidence • Effects on jobs/growth if it is stagnating • Difficulties of policy response to low levels of inflation • Possible damage to investment if firms don't see rising prices • Possible effects on inflationary expectations of low rates of current inflation • Wages may not rise causing problems in the labour market • Inflation may be below target of 2% but still within the boundary of acceptable figures 1-3% • The possibility that very low inflation could lead to deflation and the consequences. Arguments why a low inflation rate may be beneficial: • In relative terms it may boost competitiveness if the inflation rate is lower than in other countries and should benefit the current account of the balance of payments • The ability to maintain low interest rates and as a result, the effects on consumer expenditure, employment and economic growth. • The ability to maintain low interest rates and as a result, the effects on investment, employment and economic growth. • The possibility that costs can remain low, and firms do not have to pay higher wages • Cost of living arguments • Possibly allows the government's finances to improve due to not having to raise welfare payments some of which are index linked.
Evaluation	• The cause of the low rates is vital in ascertaining the potential effects • Low inflation could be beneficial in the short run as cost of living remains low, however this must be weighed up against the growth of wages • A vital aspect is how low is "low"? Low rates that are just under target may be more acceptable than low rates close to zero • The extent to which inflation "greases the wheels" of the economy • The duration of the low levels of inflation. It may be that low levels are good if sustained but a volatile low inflation rate may be damaging • The current state of the economy and the government/MPC's ability to be able to respond with credible policy • The possibility that other countries may be suffering deflation and its potential effects • Does the target rate really matter? <i>Examiners should note that, for some of the weaker or average candidates, parts of the above represent quite sophisticated evaluation and so it is important to ensure that more basic evaluation is adequately rewarded where a genuine effort has been made to display that skill.</i>

Also give credit for

- Reference to the UK / other economies
- Diagrams
- An overall judgement on the issues raised.

It will only be possible for candidates to consider a few of the above. They may also discuss other issues not mentioned above.

[25]

26.

Areas for discussion include:

- nature of monetary policy
- the Bank of England/MPC and the operation of monetary policy in the UK
- what is meant by macroeconomic stability and the indicators of macroeconomic performance
- how monetary policy affects macroeconomic performance, eg by influencing aggregate demand, influencing expectations, impacts on financial markets
- monetary policy transmission mechanisms
- role of interest rates in affecting aggregate demand
- limitations of changes in bank rate, eg likely to be less effective when confidence is low, may not be reflected in market interest rates, the lower pound problem
- quantitative easing, Funding for Lending, Forward Guidance and other less conventional monetary measures
- monetary policy as a means of fine-tuning the economy and responding to economic shocks
- monetary policy and long-run growth
- monetary policy, debt and asset prices
- monetary policy and the exchange rate
- monetary policy in a world of floating exchange rates and 'unrestricted' capital flows
- the contribution, or otherwise, of monetary policy to the period of stability (eg 1993-2006)
- the contribution of monetary policy to the credit crunch
- the impact of monetary policy since the credit crunch.

The use of relevant diagrams to support the analysis should be taken into account when assessing the quality of the candidate's response to the question.

[25]

27.

Relevant issues include:

- the nature of economic growth
- short-run versus long-run growth
- UK economic growth and living standards
- UK economic growth, tax revenues, public spending and the budget balance
- UK economic growth, inequality and poverty
- UK economic growth and employment
- UK economic growth and inflation
- UK economic growth and the balance of payments, including export-led growth
- the relationship between the government's wider political and social objectives, eg political and military power, the environment.

The use of relevant diagrams to support the analysis should be taken into account when assessing the quality of the candidate's response to the question.

[15]

28.

Explanation

For defining/explaining

- Budget deficit
- Government spending / Taxation
- Fiscal policy

**Up to 2 marks per
definition or explanation to
a maximum of 4 marks**

Award 1 mark for each step in a logical chain of reasoning

For example: As an economy goes into recession (1 mark) there may be decreased investment (1 mark) as firms have spare capacity (1 mark) which will lead to reduced purchases of capital goods (1 mark) which reduces firms outputs (1 mark) and also creates a rise in unemployment (1 mark) as labour is in derived demand (1 mark) which increases government spending on JSA (1 mark) and also provides reduced revenue in the form of decreased income tax (1 mark) which may cause a fall in consumption (1 mark) which means fewer goods and services would be sold (1 mark) which reduces indirect tax revenue in the form of VAT (1 mark) and possibly firms profits reducing corporation tax (1 mark). Other examples include: Increased reliance on public services / social provision, discretionary government spending, increased cost of government borrowing due to loss of credit rating, nationalisation / re-nationalisation, economic shocks, fiscal mismanagement.	Up to 15 marks
Use of diagrams to help support explanations, AD/AS, trade cycle	Up to 2 marks per diagram (1 mark for labelling, 1 mark for correct information shown) to a maximum of 4 marks.
Reference to the UK and/or other economies.	1 mark per reference to a maximum of 2 marks

[15]

30.

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Level 1	Very weak	0 to 3 <i>Mid-Point 2 marks</i>

Introduction	• Budget deficit • Trade deficit • The Balance of Payments
Developing the response to the question: (application and analysis)	Arguments why a trade deficit is more damaging than a budget deficit: • Could indicate lack of productivity • Could cause depreciation of currency • Could cause problems for a country's reserves • A surplus on the financing section of the balance of payments increasing international indebtedness • Deflationary pressure • Could indicate structural weaknesses • Effects on jobs such as structural unemployment Arguments why a budget deficit is more damaging than a trade deficit: • Crowding out • Loss of credit status leading to increased costs of government borrowing • Future generations footing the bill (vertically inequitable) • Possibility of tax rises / cuts in spending • Adds to national debt • Could be inflationary
Evaluation	• Both issues are not mutually exclusive, an improved supply-side performance could help both. • The UK's ability to attract FDI will help finance the capital account and may off-set any problems on the trade deficit, however this may also benefit the UK's budget deficit in terms of job creation and generating tax revenue. • Deficits on both may be necessary and advantageous, they may both benefit living standards in terms of more goods being consumed or boosting AD. • Consideration that trade-offs may take place with the other macroeconomic goals, for example reducing the budget deficit may reduce the trade deficit but at the same time harm unemployment or create deflation. <i>Examiners should note that, for some of the weaker or average candidates, parts of the above represent quite sophisticated evaluation and so it is important to ensure that more basic evaluation is adequately rewarded where a genuine effort has been made to display that skill.</i>
Also give credit for	• Reference to the UK / other economies • Diagrams • An overall judgement on the issues raised.

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